Cumberland Heights (cumberlandheights.org): the 5 SEO problems most likely costing calls and admissions

Cumberland Heights is a Nashville nonprofit (since 1966) with a 177-acre River Road campus plus 15+ outpatient sites, audited 21 Oct 2026 with github.com/leo247724/treatment-seo-audit plus OpenSEO/DataForSEO, Maps, SERP and Perplexity data. Problems are ranked by likely effect on calls, not traffic; figures are public-data estimates.

#	Problem	Likely cost in calls	Fix in one line	Check first (GSC / call tracking)
1	Not in the 3-pack for core Nashville searches; 4.0★ vs 4.7-4.9★	High	Review program; GBP aligned with the site	Calls on GBP number vs site number
2	Money keywords rank through a homepage titled "Home"	High	Service + city titles; city + program pages	GSC homepage CTR vs position
3	AI answers cite directories, skip residential	Med	FAQ answer blocks, full schema, outcomes page	GSC brand trend; "AI" source in call intake
4	Thin trust signals on health pages	Med	Medical-reviewer bylines, accreditation seals	GSC blog vs /treatment/ clicks over core updates
5	Technical SEO: sitemap, archives, phone variants, speed	Low	Clean sitemap, noindex archives, one NAP, caching	GSC Pages report; calls per number

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The 5 problems

1. Missing from the Google 3-pack for core Nashville rehab searches; main listing rates 4.0★ beside competitors at 4.7-4.9★

The residential campus is missing where mobile searchers tap to call.

Evidence

- Not in the 3-pack for "alcohol rehab nashville tn", "drug rehab nashville" or "detox nashville tn"; in it only for "inpatient rehab nashville tn" (#3) and "rehab nashville tn" (#2).
- Google Maps from downtown, mobile: River Road is absent from the top 20 for "alcohol rehab" and "drug rehab"; only the Music Row outpatient listing appears (#6-7, 4.6★, 9 reviews).
- River Road GBP: 4.0★ from 234 reviews vs 4.9★ (104-410 reviews) for every pack competitor.
- Perplexity's "Cumberland Heights reviews" answer leads with Yelp 3.0★ and billing complaints.

Why it costs calls

- On mobile the 3-pack sits above the #1 organic result the site already holds and carries the tap-to-call button; rating is the visible tiebreaker.

Fix

- Review program: ask at discharge and from alumni, answer every review, fix the 1-star themes.
- Align GBP categories, services, photos and phone with the site; UTM links to each location page; Joint Commission and insurers in the description.

Check first

- Call tracking: GBP number (866-395-6390) vs site header number (800-646-9998); GBP Insights calls by query.
- Search Console: brand-query trend as reviews land.

2. Every commercial "nashville rehab" keyword ranks through a homepage titled "Home - Cumberland Heights"

The highest-value queries land on a page titled "Home".

Evidence

- DataForSEO: "rehabs nashville tn" (2,400/mo, CPC $91) #1, "nashville rehab centers" (1,300/mo, CPC $95) #1, "drug treatment nashville tn" #1, "detox nashville tn" #4, "iop nashville tn" #18, all via the homepage.
- /treatment/drug-and-alcohol-detox and /treatment/residential-care rank for no city + program query.
- Competitors rank dedicated pages (apex.rehab/tennessee/nashville/).

Why it costs calls

- CPCs near $90 say what each click is worth; "Home" caps click-through, and one page must convert detox, residential, IOP and insurance intent at once.

Fix

- Title/H1 "Cumberland Heights | Alcohol & Drug Rehab in Nashville, TN (since 1966)"; description with 24/7, insurers, Joint Commission.
- One page per city + level of care with NAP, schema, payers and FAQ, linked from the homepage hero (the 3 readable location pages under /resources/location/ carry MedicalBusiness schema; the gap is program + city pages).

Check first

- Search Console: homepage queries containing "nashville", CTR vs position (positions 1-3 should clear 5-8%; the gap is the title); which /treatment/ URLs get impressions for "nashville detox" or "nashville iop".
- Call tracking: calls by landing page, as a baseline.

3. AI answers describe the facility from directories, not its own site, and skip it for residential treatment

AI engines quote directories, not the site.

Evidence

- Perplexity, 21 Oct: 0 of 3 non-brand Nashville queries cite cumberlandheights.org; two name the facility but source startyourrecovery.org, rehab.com and rehabnet.com.
- "Residential addiction treatment near Nashville" omits it; Freeman, APEX and Tulip Hill are cited from their own residential pages.
- Google AI Overviews cite the domain for 417 keywords, the top 50 all blog posts ("12 steps", "barbiturates"), zero program or admissions pages.
- FAQPage schema only on the detox page and the admissions FAQ (1 of 30 program pages); homepage MedicalOrganization schema has no telephone, address or sameAs. robots.txt allows every AI citation bot.

Why it costs calls

- Rehab research increasingly starts in AI tools; the cited directory gets the call and tells the billing-complaint story.

Fix

- FAQPage answer blocks on residential, insurance, admissions and location pages (cost, length of stay, coverage, what to bring).
- Complete the MedicalOrganization schema; add an outcomes/alumni page engines can cite for "reviews".

Check first

- Search Console: brand-query trend (AI exposure shows up as brand searches).
- Call tracking: add "ChatGPT/AI" to "how did you hear about us"; check server logs for OAI-SearchBot, PerplexityBot and ChatGPT-User.

4. Thin trust signals on the pages where health decisions happen

Health pages rarely show who wrote or reviewed them.

Evidence

- 2 of 32 program/blog pages show a medical reviewer or credentialed byline.
- Joint Commission appears on inner pages but not the homepage; no LegitScript mention.
- Backlinks fell from 3,621 to 3,042 in 12 months (944 referring domains, spam score 41, largest referrer a directory).

Why it costs calls

- Google's health-page quality signals, AI engines and families all weigh visible expertise and accreditation.

Fix

- "Medically reviewed by <name, credentials>" with bios on every program and blog page.
- Joint Commission and LegitScript seals in the footer; clinical team page with Person schema.

Check first

- Search Console: clicks for /resources/blog/ vs /treatment/ around the last two core updates.
- Call tracking: calls starting on blog vs program pages.

5. Technical SEO: dead sitemap URLs, thin archives, phone variants, 4-7 s page responses

The base is sound, but small leaks add up.

Evidence

- Sitemap lists 3,234 URLs, ~1,100 of them image attachments; 23 of the first 150 fetched were 404.
- Tag and member-category archives (49-133 words) are indexable.
- Six tel: numbers on site plus different numbers on GBP, Facebook, NAATP and the ads microsite; uncached blog pages take 4-7 s.
- OpenSEO (120 pages) found no critical issues: the problems are strategic, not technical.

Why it costs calls

- Low direct cost: wasted crawl budget, weaker NAP matching for #1, a slow phone number on mobile.

Fix

- Sitemap from indexable pages only; noindex tag/member-category archives.
- One canonical NAP with dynamic number insertion; full-page caching/CDN.

Check first

- Search Console: Pages ("Not found", "Crawled, currently not indexed"), Sitemaps, Core Web Vitals.
- Call tracking: calls per number.

Backlinks and domain authority

- DataForSEO domain rank 44; 4,810 backlinks from 944 referring domains.
- 12-month trend: backlinks 3,621 (Oct 2025) to 3,042 (Sep 2026), -16%; referring domains 924 to 894.
- Spam score 41 for the domain (13 for its backlinks).
- Top referrers are directories: addictiontreatments101.com (1,375 links), rehabconnectusa.com, alcoholrehabus.org, recovery.com, tennesseesober.com. Few hospital, university or news links. Competitor comparison (DataForSEO rank and referring domains):

#	Domain	DataForSEO rank	Referring domains	Backlinks	Broken	Target spam	SERP visibility
1	**cumberlandheights.org**	44	944	4,810	13	41	2.65
2	southeastaddictiontn.com	36	2,570	3,353	8	0	3.05
3	nashvilleaddictionrecovery.com	34	2,471	5,721	1	0	2.45
4	liveagaindetox.com	34	2,429	3,346	2,922	0	1.95

Cumberland Heights has the highest rank of the six, but four of the five competitors have 2.6 to 4 times as many referring domains. Monthly new/lost figures (+334 new, -309 lost) disagree with the 12-month drop, so the decline needs confirming in Search Console.

Fix

- Earn local links (hospitals, universities, county resources, Nashville news) pointed at program and city pages.

Check first

- Search Console Links report: top linking sites and target pages; whether referring domains keep dropping.

On-page optimization

Page	Title (verbatim)	Service + place?	Meta desc. length	H1	Words	FAQ	Schema beyond Organization
/	Home - Cumberland Heights	No	223	1	2,271	No	MedicalOrganization, MedicalClinic, MedicalTherapy
/treatment/residential-care/	Residential Care - Cumberland Heights	No	411	1	801	No	None
/treatment/drug-and-alcohol-detox/	Drug & Alcohol Detox - Cumberland Heights	No	360	1	1,744	Yes	FAQPage
/admissions/insurance-and-finances/	Insurance and Finances - Cumberland Heights	No	360	1	657	No	None
/locations/river-road/	River Road - Cumberland Heights	No	374	1	765	No	None

Title rewrites

- Home: "Cumberland Heights | Alcohol & Drug Rehab in Nashville, TN (since 1966)"
- Residential: "Residential Rehab in Nashville, TN | Cumberland Heights"
- Detox: "Drug & Alcohol Detox in Nashville, TN | Cumberland Heights"
- Insurance: "Rehab Insurance & Costs in Nashville, TN | Cumberland Heights"
- River Road: "Residential Rehab Campus in Nashville, TN | Cumberland Heights"

Three on-page fixes

- Cut meta descriptions (223-411 characters) to one sentence: program, Nashville, 24/7 phone, Joint Commission.
- Add a 4-6 question FAQ with FAQPage schema to residential, insurance and River Road.
- Add MedicalClinic schema with telephone, address and sameAs to program and River Road pages; fix the invalid JSON-LD block on the homepage.

Site audit. OpenSEO found no critical issues in 120 pages. Warnings: 8 missing H1s (event pages), 4 duplicate event titles, and missing alt text (17 of 69 homepage images).

GEO: brand mentions in AI answers vs competitors

Query (engine)	Mentioned	Cited	Who was cited
Best alcohol rehab in Nashville (Perplexity)	Yes, first	No	Freeman, startyourrecovery.org, rehab.com
Rehabs accepting BCBS or Aetna (Perplexity)	Yes	No	rehabseekers.com, startyourrecovery.org, recovery.com
Residential treatment near Nashville (Perplexity)	No	No	Freeman, Tulip Hill, Renaissance, APEX, tndetoxcenter.com
Cumberland Heights reviews (Perplexity)	Yes	No	yelp.com, bbb.org, indeed.com, rehabseekers.com
Is Cumberland Heights good, what insurance (Perplexity)	Yes	Yes	cumberlandheights.org, a separate cumberlandheights.com, rehab.com
alcohol / drug rehab nashville (Google)	Organic only	No	No AI Overview; pack: Recovery Unplugged, Southeast Addiction
cumberland heights (Google)	Yes	Yes	AI Overview; facebook.com, recovery.com, naatp.org

Third-party listings on the brand SERP carry four other phone numbers.

Share of voice on 8 non-brand Nashville queries (Perplexity, 21 Oct 2026; mentioned / own domain cited / average first-mention position):

Brand	Mentioned (of 8)	Own domain cited (of 8)	Own-domain citation URLs	Avg first-mention position
Freeman Recovery Center	6	7	27	2.33
APEX Recovery	3	5	6	2.0
Live Again Detox	3	2	3	2.0
Cumberland Heights	**2**	**0**	**0**	**1.0**
The Next Door Recovery	2	0	0	2.5
Southeast Addiction Center	1	1	1	1.0
Tulip Hill	1	3	3	4.0
Recovery Unplugged	0	0	0	n/a
The Ranch Tennessee / Recovery Ranch	0	0	0	n/a
Brentwood Springs Detox	0	0	0	n/a

Freeman Recovery Center is cited from its own site in 7 of 8 answers, including its insurance and cost pages. Cumberland Heights is mentioned in 2 of 8 (named first both times, but supported by directory pages) and cited from its own domain in none. The most-cited third-party domains are psychologytoday.com (6 queries), recovery.com (4) and startyourrecovery.org (3). One run on one engine: a snapshot, not a trend.

Fix

- Citable residential, insurance and outcomes pages.
- Correct NAP and program data on the cited directories; resolve cumberlandheights.com.

Check first

- Search Console: brand impressions monthly; non-brand impressions on residential-care.
- Call tracking: calls to the directory numbers.

Limits

No GSC, analytics or call data, so impact is estimated from page intent and market data. Core Web Vitals not measured (PageSpeed quota exhausted; 8 of 20 OpenSEO Lighthouse runs failed). AI answers are a one-day snapshot of 5 queries. The

~48K estimated monthly organic visits are mostly informational blog traffic ("12 step program aa" alone is ~4.8K); the pages that drive calls earn a small share.